MIL-V-44323A
27 April 1988
SUPERSEDING
MIL-V-44323(GL)
26 January 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

VEST, TACTICAL LOAD BEARING

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers a web harness load bearing vest to carry ammunition, grenades, canteen, and other equipment. The vest comes in one type and size only (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-50083	-	Bag, Plastic, Folded Garment
DDD-L-20	-	Label: For Clothing, Equipage and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-26	-	Bag, Plastic, (General Purpose)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8415

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MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

* (Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

U. S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

2-1-1981 - Vest, Tactical Load Bearing, Assembly
2-1-1989 - Buckle Assembly, Male End
2-1-1990 - Buckle Assembly, Female End
2-1-1992 - D-Ring Assembly
2-1-1997 - Vest, Back, Pattern

(Copies of drawings, publications, and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Copies should be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide samples. Samples of the end item, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this document may appear in the sample, in which case this document shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, 6.4).

3.3 Materials and components. Materials and components shall be as specified on Drawing 2-1-1981, and all subsidiary drawings and parts lists pertaining thereto. For materials or components for which it is stated "or equal", if the contractor proposes to use an item considered to be equal to the material or component specified, prior to its use the contractor shall furnish a sample of the material or component, with supporting data to the contracting officer for subsequent evaluation by the responsible military agency. Recycled materials may be used (see 6.5).

3.4 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the drawings in 2.1.2 and all subsidiary drawings and as specified herein.

3.4.1 Stitches, seams, and stitching. All stitches, seams, and stitchings, except bartacking, shall be performed using stitch type 301 with 7 to 9 stitches per inch and shall conform to FED-STD-751.

3.4.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all stitching, except box and box-x, shall be backstitched or overstitched 1 inch minimum except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. On box and box-x stitching, all ends shall be backstitched or overstitched 1/2 inch minimum. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewn.

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3.4.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1 inch (1/2 inch for box and box-x stitching) back of the end of the stitching.

b. Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1 inch in back of the defective area (1/2 inch for box and box-x stitching), continue over the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1 inch (1/2 inch for box and box-x stitching) beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.4.1.2 Automatic stitching. Automatic stitching machines may be used to perform any of the stitch patterns provided that the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met, and that at least three tying, overlapping, or back stitches are used to secure the ends of the stitching.

3.4.1.3 Bartacking. Bartacking shall be free from thread breaks and loose stitching. Bartacking shall be as follows:

Length	Width	No. of stitches
1 ± 1/16 inch	1/8 ± 1/32 inch	42
3/4 ± 1/16 inch	1/8 ± 1/32 inch	42

3.4.1.4 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a maximum length of 1/4 inch.

* 3.4.1.5 Lubrication of thread. Lubrication shall be permitted only to the extent that it does not stain the adjacent fabric. Only non-wicking lubricants shall be used.

* 3.4.2 Fusing of ends of nylon webbing, cord, and material. Ends of webbing, including bias cuts, cord and raw edges of nylon material shall be fused smooth. Fusing of webbing ends and nylon material shall be accomplished prior to assembling for stitching. The apparatus used to fuse the webbing and cord ends, and material shall be capable of providing sufficient heat to provide a smooth edge with the cut ends of the yarns fused together to prevent separation.

3.4.3 Location marks. Location marks shall not be drilled. Printed markings shall not be more than 1/32 inch in width.

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3.4.4 Repairs. Except as otherwise specified herein, repairs shall not be made to the vest.

3.4.5 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.3 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components

* 3.4.6 Setting of eyelets. Holes shall be prepunched or drilled to receive the eyelets. Holes prepunched to receive the eyelets shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the eyelet barrel so that the barrel must be forced through the hole.

3.4.6.1 Eyelets, with washer, brass. The brass eyelets with washer shall be securely clinched in a manner that will prevent detachment from or cutting of the surrounding material. The eyelets shall be clinched without splitting.

3.4.6.2 Eyelets, aluminum. The aluminum eyelets shall be installed using score setting dies conforming to J. C. Rhodes part number 1-KW-1KL and 101Y-Klom, or Stimpson Co. Part Number A 2744-7 or equal (see 6.6). The eyelet shall be securely set in a manner that will prevent detachment from, or cutting of, the adjacent material. The clinched portion of the eyelet shall be on the inside of the assembly.

* 3.4.7 Setting of grommets. Holes shall be prepunched or drilled to receive the grommets. Holes prepunched to receive the grommets shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the grommet barrel so that the barrel must be forced through the hole. The grommet shall be securely clinched without cutting the adjacent material.

* 3.4.8 Setting of snap fasteners. A hole shall be prepunched or drilled to receive the button and eyelet components of the snap fasteners. The hole shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the button and eyelet barrels so that the barrel must be forced through the hole. The hole shall not be punched in the setting operation with the button or eyelet barrel. The fasteners shall be securely clinched without cutting the adjacent materials and no more than three splits shall occur in the button or eyelet barrels.

3.5 Marking. The identification marking shall be applied in the location shown on Drawing 2-1-1997 and shall conform to type IV, class 5 of DDD-L-20. The letters "US" shall be applied in the size characters and in the location indicated on Drawing 2-1-1981 and shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. Fastness of class 9 marking shall be as specified for class 5 marking.

3.6 Patterns. Standard patterns for textile components other than tape or webbing are shown full scale on drawings and provide allowances for all seams and shall be used for making working patterns. The standard patterns shall not be altered in any way.

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3.7 Workmanship. The finished vest shall be clean. The textile components shall be free of defects, such as holes, tears, loose weaving, or unfused ends. The hardware shall be free of corroded areas, sharp edges, or unfinished areas.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point, or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.3 Certificate of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3, 4.4.4 and 4.4.5. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

* 4.4.1.1 Certification. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance for the buckle specified on Drawings 2-1-1989 and 2-1-1990, for the D-rings specified on Drawing 2-1-1992, the cord-lock specified on Drawing 2-1-1981 (see 6.7).

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing operation to determine whether cut lengths, cut parts, markings for location of components, and location of assembled component parts are in accordance with the specified requirements. In addition, inspection shall be made to determine that prepunched holes for receiving eyelets, grommets, and snap fasteners, are smaller than the outside diameter of the hardware barrel. Whenever nonconformance is noted, corrections shall be made to the parts affected and the lot in process. Parts which cannot be corrected shall be removed from production.

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of vests. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated vest. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 15 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Nylon duck cloth	Any hole, cut, tear, smash, broken or missing yarn, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet).	X	
	Shade bar or abrasion mark.		X
Webbing or tape, nylon	Any hole, cut, tear, or smash.	X	
	Not firmly and tightly woven, edges frayed or scalloped.	X	
	Multiple floats.		X
	Abrasion mark, slub, broken end or pick.	X	
	Cut ends of webbing not fused as specified.	X	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Side drawstrings	Cut, chafed, or abraded.	X	
	Ends not fused.		X
	Not threaded through eyelets or knotted as specified.		X
	Omitted.	X	
Fastener tape	Any hole, cut, or tear.	X	
	Hooks flattened, broken, or missing, impairing function.	X	
Hardware	Broken or malformed, failing to serve, intended purpose, corroded area, burr, or sharp edge.	X	
	Finish omitted or not as specified:		
	- on brass or aluminum components		X
	- on steel components.	X	
	Area of partial or no finish.		X
	Any required component improperly installed causing failure to serve intended purpose.	X	
	Not assembled as specified.	X	
	Size or type not as specified.	X	
Snap fasteners	Any fastener not functioning properly i.e., fails to snap closed, to provide a secure closure, or to open freely.	X	
	NOTE: The fasteners shall be snapped and unsnapped twice to determine whether parts of fastener separate freely and also effect a secure closure.		
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting adjacent material.	X	
	Clinched loosely, permitting any component to rotate freely but not to the degree that any component can be expected to become detached during use.		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Snap fasteners (cont'd)	Clinched loosely to the degree that components can be expected to become detached during use.	X	
NOTE:	Incomplete roll of end of button or eyelet barrel is evidence of improper and insecure clinching.		
	Incorrect style.	X	
	More than three splits in eyelet or button barrels.		X
Brass grommets and eyelets	Clinched excessively tight, cutting adjacent material.	X	
	Insecurely clinched to a degree that grommet or eyelet may be detached from material.	X	
	Washer installed on incorrect side of material.		X
	Eyelet barrel split.		X
Eyelets, aluminum	Insecurely clinched; clinched excessively tight, cutting fabric.	X	
	Not set with scored setting.	X	
	Installed with scored side on outside.		X
Cord lock	Reversed.		X
Buckle, side release (plastic)	Color not as specified.		X
	Color not molded in.		X
	Broken, cracked, chipped, or malformed, failing to serve intended purpose.	X	
	Any sink mark.		X
	Any burr, sharp edge, or flash.	X	
	Gates not trimmed as specified.		X
	Surface not smooth.		X
	Not functioning properly, failing to effect a secure closure or to open freely.	X	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Seams and stitching:			
Open seam	1/2 inch or less.		X
	More than 1/2 inch.	X	
NOTE:	A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches occur. On double stitched seams, a seam shall be considered open when either one or both sides of the seam are open.		
Raw edge (on edge required to be finished)	More than 1/2 inch when securely caught in stitching.		X
NOTE:	Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as an open seam.		
Run-off (see open seam)			
Seam and stitch type	Wrong seam or stitch type.	X	
Bartacks	Any bartack omitted.	X	
	Any bartack not as specified or not in specified location.		X
	Loose, incomplete, or broken stitches.		X
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in loose bobbin or top thread.		X
	Excessively tight, resulting in puckering of material.		X
Stitches per inch	Up to two stitches less than minimum specified.		X
	Three or more stitches less than minimum specified.	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified.		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Seams and stitching: (cont'd)	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the fabric in order to sew over heavy seams, or in turning corners shall be classified as follows: (a) Within the minor defect classification - no defect (b) Within the major defect classification - minor defect.		
Stitching ends	Not secured as specified.		X
Thread breaks, skipped stitches, or runoffs	Not overstitched as specified.		X
	NOTE: Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches not overstitched shall be classified as an open seam.		
Rows of stitching	Any row missing except on box and box-x stitching.	X	
	On box and box-x stitching: - one row of stitching omitted		X
	- two or more rows of stitching omitted.	X	
Components and assembly	Any component part omitted or not as specified or any operation omitted or not as specified (unless otherwise classified herein).	X	
	Any needle chew: - up to 1/8 inch in length		X
	- over 1/8 inch in length.	X	
	Any mend, darn, patch, splice, or other unauthorized repair.	X	
	Any material pleated or caught in stitching where not specified.		X

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Binding	Loosely applied but not exposing raw edge of material.		X
	Loosely applied exposing raw edge of material.	X	
	Ends of binding on pocket flap and on ammunition pockets not caught in seams.		X
	Ends of binding on pocket flap and on grenade pockets not caught in seams.		X
Darts (on ammunition pocket flaps)	One or more omitted.		X
	Not formed and sewn separately on ammunition pocket flap as specified.	X	
Ammunition and grenade pocket and flaps	Pocket is single ply construction.	X	
	Pocket or flap not formed as specified.		X
	Flaps improperly set or distorted failing to effect a full and smooth closure.	X	
	Binding tape not securely attached.		X
Cleanness	Grease, oil, dirt or ink stains clearly noticeable.		X
	Thread ends not trimmed as specified.		X
Location markings	Drilled.	X	
	Printed marking more than 1/32 inch in width or not covered by component part.		X
Markings: US identification and instructions	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced, or size of characters not as specified.		X

4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of vests. The sample unit shall be one vest. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5 for major defects and 15 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

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TABLE II. End item dimensional defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Dimensions (overall)	Smaller than nominal dimensions less applicable minus tolerance indicated on drawings, but not smaller than nominal dimensions less twice the applicable minus tolerance.		X
	Smaller than nominal dimensions less twice the applicable minus tolerance.	X	
	Larger than nominal dimensions and applicable plus tolerance.		X
Component and location dimensions	Not within specified tolerance.		X
Stitch margin or gage	Not within specified tolerance.		X
Box and box-x stitching	Dimensions not as specified.		X
Brass eyelets	Not spaced on vest panels and vest back within specified dimensions.		X
Pocket and flaps	Not parallel (vertically) to each other by more than 1/4 inch.		X
Grommets	Set off center on pocket bottoms by more than 1/4 inch.		X

4.4.5 Fit examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of vests. The sample unit shall be one vest. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

Examine	Defect
Fit of magazines into pockets and closure of flap	Pocket(s) too small, i.e., magazines fail to fit properly within the pocket.

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Examine	Defect
	NOTE: The 30-round ammunition magazine fit examination shall be performed with the magazines to be furnished by the contracting activity (see 6.3). The magazines shall be inserted into the pockets. (Two each in the outside pockets, and one each in the inside pockets.) The open ends of the magazines shall face up with the outline of the ammunition at the open end pointing towards the center front of the vest. It shall be possible to insert the magazine within the pocket without effort other than that necessary to overcome friction between the magazines and the pocket. A defect shall be scored if any magazine must be forced into the pocket(s).
	Pocket body or flap too short, causing inability to secure fastener without applying excessive force.
	NOTE: With the six magazines in the pockets, the pocket flaps shall be closed and the snap fasteners shall be secured. It shall be possible to secure the snap fastener(s) without effort other than that necessary to insert the cap into the socket receptacle. A defect shall be scored if it is necessary to force the flap down in order to secure the snap fastener.
Fit of grenade into grenade pocket(s)	Grenade pocket(s) too small, i.e., grenade fails to fit properly within pocket.
	NOTE: The grenade fit examination shall be performed with a dummy wooden grenade to be furnished by the contracting activity (see 6.3). The examination shall be performed with the two grenade pockets properly installed on the vest and with the flaps closed. Insert the grenade into the pocket with the safety pin on top and the grenade release handle positioned in the grenade hanger located on the back inside of pocket. It shall be possible to insert the grenade fully within each pocket without effort other than that necessary to overcome friction between the grenade and the pocket(s). A defect shall be scored if the grenade must be forced into the pocket(s).

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Examine	Defect
Securing of grenade retainer flaps	Grenade retaining flap too short, causing inability to secure snap fastener without applying excessive force.

NOTE: With the grenade in the pocket(s) it shall be possible to secure the grenade retaining flap without having to put excessive force on the flap to the degree that the flap is under tension after being secured.

4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and unit pack)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of bundles per container is more or less than specified.

4.4.7 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each vest shall be folded with the shoulders down in the back and then in half, side to side having approximate dimensions of 16 inches in length, 8 inches in width, and 3-1/2 inches in depth. The vest shall then be placed in a clear polyethylene bag conforming to type I or II, style 1 or 2 of PPP-B-26, or a plastic bag conforming to A-A-50083. Style 1 bag shall have a 1/4 inch hole located near a bottom corner to allow air to escape.

5.1.2 Commercial. Each vest shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Twelve vests preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be approximately 17 inches in length, 16 inches in width, and 20 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed, and reinforced with strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Twelve vests preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF, (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be approximately 17 inches in length, 16 inches in width, and 20 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III, as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

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5.2.3 Commercial packing. Vests preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), vests, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3 shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet types shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV , or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be number 95 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable. Each unit pack shall have attached a manila colored paper shipping tag for the identification information.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tactical load bearing vest is intended for use by Military personnel as an outer garment for the purpose of carrying six 30-round ammunition magazines for the M-16 rifle, and two grenade pockets for carrying fragmentation grenades. The vest is also compatible with the standard equipment belt, and the large field pack with frame and combat "patrol pack".

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article sample is required (see 3.2, 4.3, and 6.4).
c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation, and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
e. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples of 30-round ammunition magazines, and dummy grenades required for the fit examination in 4.4.5, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

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6.5 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the document (see 3.3).

6.6 Die, eyelet, score setting. Sources of supply for the score setting die specified in 3.4.6.2 are J. C. Rhodes and Company, Box 962, New Bedford, MA 02745, and Stimpson Co., Inc., Bayport, NY 11705.

6.7 Side release buckle, D-rings, and cord lock. Source of supply for the 1 inch side release buckles, 1-1/2 inch "D" rings and the cord locks specified on Drawings 2-1-1989, 2-1-1990, 2-1-1992 and 2-1-1981 is ITW NEXUS, 230 West Gerry Drive, Wood Dale, IL 60191.

6.8 International standardization agreements. Certain provisions of this document are the subject of international standardization agreement number STANAG 2311. When amendment, revision, or cancellation of this agreement is proposed which will effect or violate the international agreement concerned, the preparing activity will take appropriate reconciliation action through international standardization channels including departmental standardization offices, if required.

6.9 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ammunition carrier
Grenade carrier
Tactical load bearing
Vest

* 6.10 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-V-44323A	VEST, TACTICAL LOAD Bearing

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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